

Kyoto, Japan

Climate

Humid subtropical with four distinct seasons. Hot, humid summers near 33 C with a rainy spell in June; cold, crisp winters with the occasional snowfall.

Best time to visit

Late March to early April for cherry blossoms and November for autumn foliage - both spectacular and crowded. Summer is hot and humid; winter is quiet and atmospheric.

Top attractions

The thousands of vermillion torii gates at Fushimi Inari, the Golden Pavilion (Kinkaku-ji), the Arashiyama bamboo grove, the historic Gion geisha district, and the hillside Kiyomizu-dera temple.

Food

Multi-course kaiseki dining, yudofu (tofu hot pot), delicate matcha sweets, refined Buddhist vegetarian cuisine, and street snacks at Nishiki Market.

Visa & safety

Extremely safe with very low crime; the main etiquette is respect at temples and shrines. Many nationalities receive visa-free short stays - confirm the current rules for your passport before travel.